MYP Speaking exam format

For teachers and students

Format

Internal assessment details

- Individual speaking assessment
- Duration: 15–17 minutes, including 10 minutes of preparation time
- Weighting: 25%

The individual speaking assessment is based on the language acquisition topic list. The aim of this assessment is to measure the student's ability to understand and produce communication in the target language, and to use it for successful interaction.

The task assesses the degree to which students are able to:

- communicate clearly and effectively in a range of contexts and for a variety of purposes
- understand and use language appropriate to a range of interpersonal and/or intercultural contexts and audiences
- understand and use language to express and respond to a range of ideas
- identify, organize and present ideas on a range of topics
- understand, analyse and reflect within the context of presentation and conversation.

The language acquisition individual speaking assessment is divided into two parts, preceded by a timed period of supervised preparation. The timings of each section for each level are as listed below.

Format

IMPORTANT

Timings for the MYP language acquisition interactive speaking task

	Emergent	Capable	Proficient
Supervised preparation time The student is shown a multimodal stimulus relating to a topic or theme from the course. The stimulus must be labelled in the target language with the topic or theme to which it relates. During this time, the student is allowed to make brief working notes.	10 minutes	10 minutes	10 minutes
Presentation The student describes the multimodal stimulus and relates it to the relevant target language culture(s).	1 minute	1½ minutes	2 minutes
Interactive discussion The student engages with the teacher on the topic or theme of the stimulus.	2 minutes	2½ minutes	3 minutes
Time for student speaking	**3 minutes**	**4 minutes**	**5 minutes**
Total time of recording	**5 minutes max**	**6 minutes max**	**7 minutes max**

Stimulus material

The teacher creates a range of multimodal stimuli linked to the five MYP language acquisition topics studied during the course and labels each one in the target language. For the purposes of the individual speaking assessment, a stimulus may be an image, a poster, an illustration, an advertisement or a short written message, for example a caption or quote. Any language that naturally appears on the image should be minimal and must be in the target language. It must not provide vocabulary and structures that would give a student an unfair advantage.

An effective multimodal stimulus is one that:

- is clearly relevant to one of the five topics in the course
- is culturally relevant to the target language

Student notes (created during preparation time)

- Make bullet points
- Use them as prompts
- Not a script
- “Spontaneous” conversation

The 5 MYP themes

1. Identity and culture

Self, family, friends
Free time and leisure
Food and drink and health
Festivals and celebrations

2. Education and the world of work

School life
Future plans
Jobs

3. The world we live in

The weather
The environment
Global issues

4. Local area, travel and tourism

House and home
Local area
Holidays
Culture and communities

5. Technology and the media

Mobile technology
Social media
Artificial intelligence